

Rep. Tom Emmer on The Bottom Line

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REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, Degan, great to be with you. I think people should remember this president makes decisions. You remember back when Barack Obama was in the White House, he gave a red line in a different conflict and then when the red line was ignored, he did nothing about it. This president, the president of peace, that is his goal. He made a goal to resolve this conflict. The Iranians broke the deal. I know they want to tell you and me and everybody else that the Americans broke the deal. When they start going after private entities in the Hormuz Strait, they're the ones that are causing the problem. And the president said, enough, you're not going to get a nuclear weapon. We're not going to deal with you like all of my predecessors have dealt with you, which is we're going to call it a piece and let you keep doing the bad things that you're doing. I have the utmost confidence in President Trump and the Secretary of War, Pete Hanks, and all of the military folks that are on this. I believe you're going to see the Strait of Hormuz opened up and you're going to see the actions of this president generate peace in the Middle East and more importantly, freedom for the Iranian people who have been under the foot of this evil regime for far too long. But the exercise today in the House, kind of ridiculous, right? We got done doing a budget resolution. We got done doing the National Defense Authorization Act. We got done doing the Stock Act, some really important stuff, voter ID. We got done with the SAVE Act. And what? We've got some cute folks who, you know, it's going to come to nothing. They want to pull the rug out from underneath our president at the wrong time, in the wrong way. And by the way, it's not going to have any impact. I believe President Trump, Secretary Hegseth, will finish this shortly. And then we'll, people, those polls that you're showing, it's based on where we're at. When this gets resolved and the Strait is open and the world is safer because the Iranian regime doesn't have nuclear weapons, I think you're going to see those poll numbers be very strong for President Trump's actions. DAGAN McDOWELL: Let me move on to some of that SAVE America Act stuff, Whip Emmer, if I could. The House officially on recess after passing the budget resolution to kickstart Reconciliation 3.0, with SAVE America efforts in it, as you said, and sending it to the Senate. New Fox News polling out tonight telling how Americans are feeling about voter ID requirements. 83% support it for voter registration, 77% for actual voting. When you break it down by party, still a vast majority of Americans support it. Among Democrats, 72% want it for registering, 62% want it for voting, and for independents, it's even higher. So calling it an 80-20 issue, not an exaggeration. So Whip Emmer, here's my question for you. You got a little bit of that in what you passed today, okay? It's kind of a carrot approach, I'm hearing it called. If states do some of the SAVE America Act stuff, they get money as a reward. But it doesn't sound like there's any stick in there. And so what I'm wondering is, is this going to end up being the deal where red states are going to do it and take the money, and blue states, where you probably need it the most, aren't going to take the money and aren't going to do it? Am I understanding this correctly? What did you guys do today?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, we passed the budget resolution and attached the SAVE Act to it. Yes, what the White House has said to us, because this was a request, obviously, the SAVE Act is a SAVE America Act, is one of the president's top priorities, makes sense. We need to have fair and honest elections in this country. All right, it's very common

sense. Brian, you just pointed out, this isn't a Republican-Democrat thing, this is a common sense thing that most Americans agree with, 80-20? I wonder why the 20 even question it when you start talking to them about the only reason you wouldn't want this is because you want to cheat. The ask was, send it over this way, we're going to work with the Senate to see if there's a way that we can get the majority of the SAVE Act passed into law using a financial hook of grants to different states. But quite frankly, I wish people would report more that all they need are 50 votes plus one. I know they talk about the filibuster all the time, but does everybody realize that if the parliamentarian were to throw out the SAVE America Act from the budget resolution once the instructions, the bill is actually built, it only takes 50 plus one senators to overrule the parliamentarian. Get the darn thing passed. If you can't pass an 80% issue through the US Senate that's controlled by Republicans, I don't know what we're doing.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

Really quickly with Emma, Steve Scalise, the House Majority Leader said to John Thune, the Majority Leader in the Senate, figure out a way to get it done. You have served this up on a platter to them by putting it, elements of the SAVE America Act into the reconciliation plan. And here's what we know, that Thune has said, it appears as if he will not move the budget resolution before the August recess. He also signaled that he could hold it until Congress reaches a deal to fund the government ahead of the September 30th deadline. And there's some Republican senators who don't think that they're going to take up this budget resolution, punting it until after the midterms. I would be red mad if I were y'all.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, you know, I've gone at it. I am very upset. You've heard me just say, you've got an 80% issue. You can't pass it through a Republican Senate, please. This is ridiculous. Democrats should be supported. But let's put that aside for a second. I respect the leader's right to make his own decisions. I don't have to agree with. But I got to ask him, why would your own people say no to this? What what is the issue over there that these four or five Republican members have a problem with people establishing their citizenship, that they're a citizen for purposes of voting and that when they show up to cast that ballot, having a photo ID to prove who they are, Dagan, why who would oppose that? I just that's the part that's hard to understand. This is what they're going to have to get through their heads over there. And I'm not telling them how to do their business. But the American people are demanding. DAGAN McDOWELL: Yes, they are. The American people have had enough of this. And Brian pointed out, it's not just Republicans. It's all Americans. Yeah.

BRIAN KILMEADE:

Yeah. Republicans got to get on the same page with and, you know, maybe you got to tell them how to do their business. I don't know, because Americans want to see this get done with them are great to see you. Thanks for joining us tonight. We appreciate it.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you, guys.

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